



GREY BANNER ALERT



SHW Serious Incident (SI) – Final Notice

Date of Incident:	17/11/22	Time of Incident:	Approx. 12.25pm
Region / Directorate:	HVS	Main Roads or Contractor:	Contractor
EQSafe Event Type:	SHW Near Miss	EQSafe Incident Number:	29072
Actual Consequence:	Minor	Potential Consequence:	Major

Incident Short Description:	Worker experiences microsleep, resulting in vehicle veering off road.
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Executive Summary:

On 17th November 2022, a worker was on empty travel southbound from Mount Magnet and was considering stopping for a break; however he noticed that he was only 149km from Wubin, so made the decision to stop there instead. Driver was not aware of any signs of fatigue at the time but did note that he had watery eyes.

Approximately 60km from Wubin, the vehicle has veered off the road as the worker experienced a microsleep. Dashcam footage has shown the vehicle travelling at 110km/hr when it left the road and hit the road shoulder (narrowly avoiding a concrete drain culvert) travelling through bush scrub and then coming to a stop after the driver woke and regained control of the vehicle.



Image of vehicle veering off road, narrowly avoiding concrete culvert

Contributing Factors:

- The drivers own vigilance system was bypassed when he delayed his fatigue break
- The driver did not recognise that watery eyes were a sign of fatigue.
- The sudden onset of tiredness could have been related to positive testing of COVID-19 the following day.
- No vigilance monitoring devices installed in vehicles (eg. Telematics, eye sensors).

Corrective Actions:

- Fatigue Management procedures to be updated to include the possible cause of fatigue as being COVID-19.
- Workers to complete annual Commercial Driver Fatigue Management training.
- Vehicles to be installed with vigilance monitoring devices, including consideration for infrared biometric sensors (pupil tracking).

Additional Issues/Learnings:



Critical Risk:

This serious potential incident aligns with the Main Roads Critical Risk Profile relating to **Vehicles and Driving.**

Distribution of Notice:

Main Roads Personnel and Contracting Organisations